

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ K 8

♣ 10 9 8 4 2

♠ 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q J 7



♠ Q 9 5

♥ K 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 5 3

♣ 6

♠ A K 8 7 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A 10 2

♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	1♠
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Pass	4♠		3♠
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All Pass

4♠ by South

the ♣ suit without anyone trumping in.

Of course you open 1♠. Partner responds 2♣.

With 17 points and a 6-card suit you jump to 3♠.

Partner bids the game.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥Q.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have plenty of ♣ winners in dummy but you must be careful because there are no outside entries.

You win your ♥A and play ♠A and ♠K, both defenders following suit. The ♠Q is still out. To make sure you get to enjoy those ♣ winners you should continue with another ♠, forcing out the ♠Q. The defense will now take a ♥ if they are smart, but the rest of the tricks are yours because you can run

Think through what would have happened if you had not forced out the ♠Q.

East would have used his master ♠Q to ruff the second ♣, before you had taken any discards. You would still have to lose a ♥ and two ♦s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 2

♥ A 7 2

♦ 7 4

♣ J 10 6 4 3

♠ A J 3

♥ 10 8 6 4

♦ Q 9 6 5

♣ 8 7



♠ Q 10 7

♥ K 9 5

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ K Q 2

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ A K 2

♣ A 9 5

West

North

East

South

All Pass

1NT by South

1NT

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 6

You only need one more winner and there are possibilities in ♠s, ♥s and ♦s. But you need to be very careful. If you watched those ♣ spots you will realize that West started with 5 ♣s (he led the ♣4, later played the ♣3). So the defenders will win 2 more ♣ tricks to go with the 2 they already have. And they can also take the ♥A and ♥K whenever they want. In other words, they also have 6 winners. So the battle is for the 7th trick for either side. If you do anything that gives them a trick they will win.

So you don't try for a trick in ♠s or ♦s. Instead you play on ♥s, the suit where they have the 2 sure winners anyway. They will win one of their high honors, take their 2 ♣s, then play either ♠s or ♦s. You win and drive out the other ♥ honor.

If you try to get a winner by taking the ♠ finesse you will give **THEM** a winner and you will go down.

If you play your three high ♦s you will set up a winner for **THEM** and you will go down.

Only if you establish your ♥s can you set up a winner for **YOU** without giving them an extra trick.

North's 1NT opening shows a maximum of 17 points. Add your 7 and you come up with only 24 - not enough to think about game. So you pass.

North would play 1NT.

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South plays 1NT. West leads the ♣4. East plays the ♣Q, then the ♣K, West playing the ♣3 on the second trick. East then plays the ♣2 which you win with your ♣A.

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